MIL-C-43681A(GL)

18 July 1973

SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-43681
24 November 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASE, MAINTENANCE EQUIPMENT, SMALL ARMS, M14A1

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for one type of nylon carrying case.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-285	-	Thread, Polyester
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping
DDD-L-20	-	Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (Ceneral Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-W-4088	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon
MIL-T-5038	-	Tape, Textile and Webbing, Textile, Reinforcing, Nylon
MIL-H-9890	-	Hardware, Individual Lead Carrying Equipment: and Hardware, Miscellaneous
MIL-P-21922	-	Plastic Rods and Tubes, Polyethylene
MIL-W-27265	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon Impregnated
MIL-C-43128	-	Cloth, Plain Weave, Nylon: Water Repellent, OG-106

FSC 8465

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads for 40" x 48" Pallets

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK LABORATORIES

2-2-245 - Case, Maintenance Equipment, Small Arms, M14A1; Assembly Complete

(Figure 1 is a miniature reproduction of referenced drawing and is attached for information only.)

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.3). Variations from the specification may appear in the sample, in which case the specification shall govern.

* 3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3, and 6.4).

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Cloth, nylon. The nylon cloth shall be Olive Green 106, water repellent, conforming to MIL-C-43128.

3.3.2 Webbing, nylon. The nylon webbing shall be 2-1/4 inches wide, Olive Drab 7 conforming to type VIIIc of MIL-W-4088 and shall be resin impregnated in accordance with class R of MIL-W-27265.

3.3.3 Tape, nylon. The nylon tape for the tie tapes shall be 3/8 inch wide, Olive Drab 7 conforming to type III of MIL-T-5038.

3.3.4 Thread, polyester. The thread for all stitching shall be type I, class 1, subclass B of V-T-285. For all stitching except overedging, the thread shall be size E. For overedge stitching, the thread shall be size B.

* 3.3.4.1 Color. The thread shall be dyed Olive Drab S-1 (C.A. 66022), and shall show fastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard sample (see 6.3).

3.3.5 Keeper, with slide. The keeper, with slide, shall conform to type X of MIL-K-9890.

3.3.6 Plastic tube, polyethylene. The polyethylene plastic tube to be placed in the 1-1/8 inch by 3-1/4 inch pocket shall be 2-5/8 ± 1/16 inches long with a nominal outside diameter of 1/2 inch and a wall thickness of 1/16 inch, type I, class L, grade 1, 2 or 3, form B, natural color, conforming to MIL-P-21922.

3.4 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to Drawing 2-2-245 and be as specified herein.

3.4.1 Stitching, machine. Stitching shall conform to FED-STD-751 as follows:

For all stitching except overedge stitching	Stitch type 301, 8 to 10 stitches per inch
For overedge stitching	Type 504 or 505, 8 to 12 stitches per inch, 1/8 (+ 1/16, - 1/32) inch gage

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3.4.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Unless otherwise specified, ends of all 301 stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched 1/2 inch minimum except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn.

* 3.4.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during sewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of one inch back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of one inch in back of the defective area, continue over the defective area and continue a minimum of one inch beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

* 3.4.1.2 Types 504 and 505 stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. All repairs shall be in accordance with 3.4.1.1.1a and 3.4.1.1.1b, except substitute 3/4 inch for one inch wherever one inch appears.

3.4.1.3 Automatic stitching. Automatic machines may be used to perform any of the required stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, size and type of thread are met; and at least three tying, overlapping or backstitches are used to secure the ends of the stitching.

3.4.1.4 Lubrication of thread. There shall be no lubrication of the thread by any means, prior to or during sewing (see 4.4.1.1).

* 3.4.1.5 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch.

* 3.4.2 Fusing of ends of nylon tape and webbing. Unless otherwise specified, all ends of nylon tape and webbing shall be fused smooth and even. The apparatus used to fuse the tape and webbing ends shall be capable of providing sufficient heat to provide a smooth edge with the cut ends of the tape and webbing yarns all fused together. Fusing of the webbing ends shall be accomplished prior to being assemblied for stitching.

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3.4.3 Insertion of plastic tube. The plastic tube specified in 3.3.6 shall be inserted full length in the 1-1/8 inch by 3-1/4 inch pocket of the case.

* 3.4.4 Location marks. Location marks shall not be drilled.

* 3.4.5 Repairs. Except as otherwise specified herein, repairs are not allowed to be made to the case.

3.4.6 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2.1, shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.

3.5 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the location shown on Drawing 2-2-245 and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20. The letters "US" shall be applied in the location and in the size characters indicated on the drawing and shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. Fastness of the class 9 marking shall be as specified for class 5 marking.

3.6 Workmanship. The finished case shall conform to the quality established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

* 4.3 First article. When required (see 6.2), the first article submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.4.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship, dimensional, and assembly requirements.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except when otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Certification. The supplier shall furnish a certificate of compliance for the requirement specified in 3.4.1.4.

4.4.2 Inspection of the end item. The classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with the lists shown in 4.4.2.1 and 4.4.2.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one finished case.

4.4.2.1 Visual examination.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cloth	Any hole, cut or tear.	X	
	Any abrasion marks, broken or missing yarns, or multiple floats.	X	
	Any mend, darn or patch.	X	
	Needle chews:		
	- on flap.		X
	- on body.	X	
Webbing and tape	Any hole, cut or tear.	X	
	Frayed or scalloped edges, not firmly or tightly woven.		X
	Needle chews:		
	- up to 1/8 inch in length.		X
	- 1/8 inch or more in length.	X	
	Ends not fused or not fused as specified.		X
Keeper, with slide	Broken or malformed, corroded area, burrs or sharp edges.	X	
	Finish omitted or not as specified.	X	
	Improperly installed.		X
	Slide component of keeper jams in open, partly closed, or closed position.	X	

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4.5 First article. When first article inspection is required, the

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
	NOTE: The slide component of the keeper shall be fully closed and opened twice to determine whether slide operates freely.		
Open seams	Less than 1/2 inch.		X
	1/2 inch or more.	X	
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as an open seam when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs occur.		
Raw edges (except where required)	More than 1/2 inch when securely caught in stitching.		X
	NOTE: Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as open seam.		
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type.	X	
	Seams pleated or badly puckered.		X
Stitching tension	Tension loose, resulting in loose bobbin or top thread.		X
	Tension tight, resulting in tightness or puckering of material.		X
Stitches per inch	One to two stitches less than minimum specified.		X
	Three or more stitches less than minimum specified.	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified.		X
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by operator speeding up the machine and pulling the material in order to sew over heavy places, or in turning corners shall be classified as follows:		

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
	(a) Within the minor defect classification - No defect. (b) Within the major defect classification - Minor defect.		
Thread breaks, skipped stitches or runoffs (on type 301 stitching)	Overstitched less than one inch in each direction beyond defective stitching area.		X
Thread breaks, and skipped stitches (on types 504 and 505 stitching)	Overstitched less than 3/4 inch in each direction beyond the defective stitching area.		X
NOTE:	On all types of stitching, thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped stitched or runoffs not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.		
Stitching ends (on type 301 stitching)	Ends of stitching not secured as specified (except when caught in other stitching or turned under in a hem).		X
Rows of stitching	Any row missing.	X	
Cleanness	Grease or oil stains clearly noticeable, thread ends not trimmed throughout as specified.		X
Components and assembly	Any component omitted or not as specified, or required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein).	X	
Marking:			
"US" on front and identification on back of flap	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced.		X

* 4.4.2.2 Examination for dimensions.

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Overall dimensions of case and plastic tube	Smaller than nominal dimensions less applicable minus tolerance, but not smaller than twice the applicable minus tolerance.		X
	Smaller than nominal dimensions less twice the applicable minus tolerance.	X	
	Larger than nominal dimensions and applicable plus tolerance.		X
All dimensions other than overall including stitch margin or gauge.	Not within specified tolerance.		X

4.4.2.3 Inspection level and acceptable quality level (AQL). Inspection levels and AQLs expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

Examination	Inspection level	AQL
For defects in 4.4.2.1	II	2.5 Major 6.5 Total major and minor defects
For defects in 4.4.2.2	S-3	2.5 Major 10.0 Total major and minor defects

4.4.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.

* 4.4.3.1 Examination for packaging, packing and marking. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per 100 units.

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Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged. Any component not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of cases per container is more or less than specified. Number of cases per bundle is more or less than specified. 1/

1/ For this defect, one bundle shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

4.4.3.2 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Not as specified. Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A. Each case, with keeper closed, shall be laid out flat, full length. Twenty-five cases shall be neatly stacked, alternately reversed top to bottom, to form a bundle. The bundle shall be securely tied at each end with cotton tape or twine.

5.1.2 Level C. Cases shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A. Four hundred cases, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a taped box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat, two in length, four in width, and two in depth within a shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each fiberboard container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2 Level B. Four hundred cases, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a taped box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat, two in length, four in width, and two in depth within a shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

* 5.2.3 Level C. Cases, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

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6. Unit, intermediate package, case [illegible]

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), cases packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Each interior package shall have attached a manila colored paper shipping tag for the identification information.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The case is designed for carrying cleaning equipment and tools for the care and maintenance of the M14A1 rifle.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article sample is required (see 3.2, 4.2 and 6.4).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

* 6.4 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of one completed case. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments, regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 Marginal code identification. The outside margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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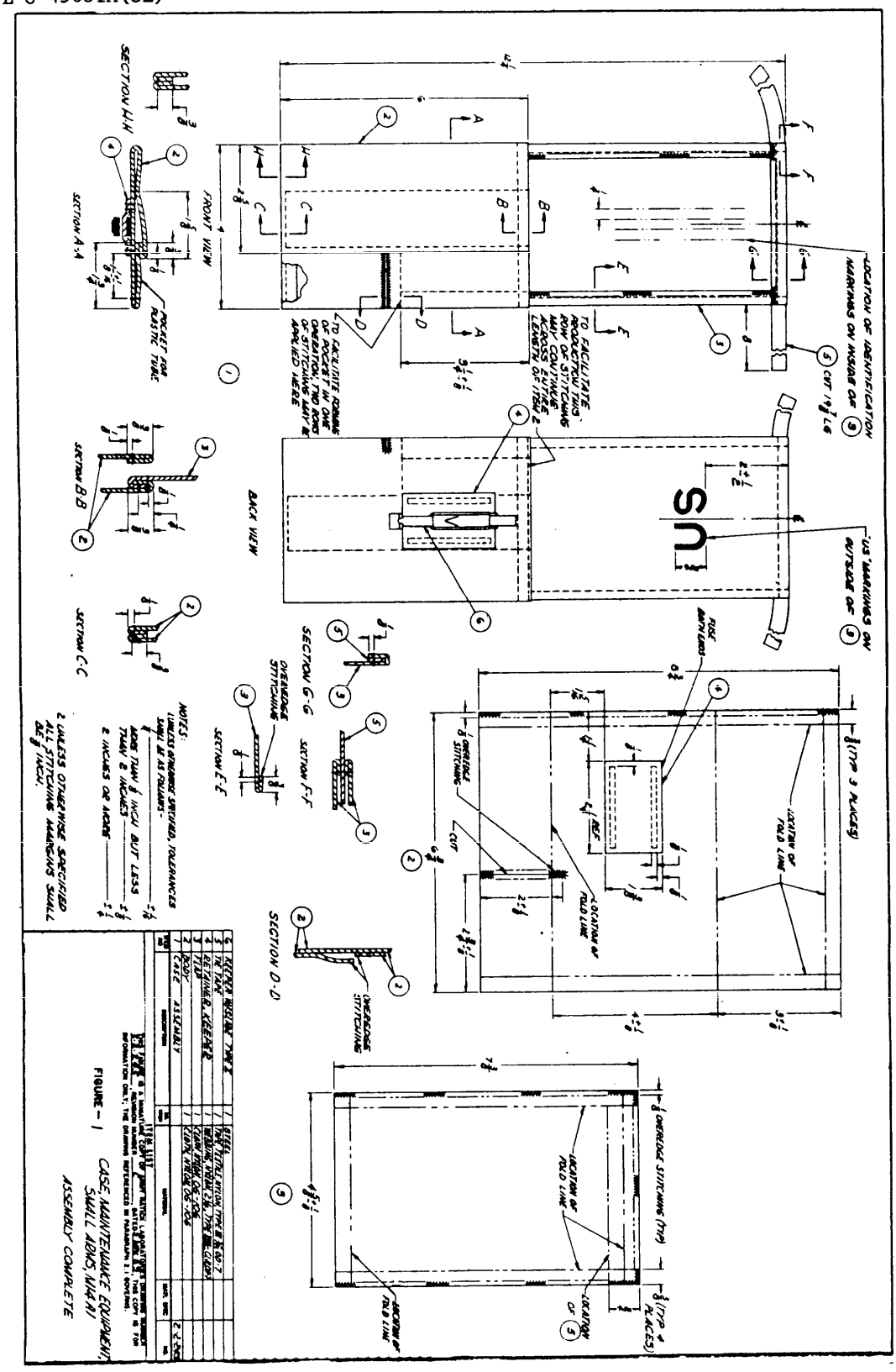
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ITEM	QTY	PART OR IDENTIFYING NUMBER	NOMENCLATURE OR DESCRIPTION	MATERIAL
5	1		RECEIVER WEBBING STRAP	
4	1		RETAINER, KEEPER	
3	1		STRAP	
2	1		BODY ASSEMBLY	
1	1		CASE ASSEMBLY	

FIGURE - 1 CASE, MAINTENANCE EQUIPMENT, SMALL ARMS, M14A1 ASSEMBLY COMPLETE

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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